use, it is firmly embedded in our constitutional and legal frameworks as a bulwark against iniquitous methods of prosecution. It protects the individual from any disclosure, in the form of oral testimony, documents or chattels, sought by legal process against him as a witness.

Since the privilege against self-incrimination is a purely personal one, it cannot be utilized by or on behalf of any organization, such as a corporation. *Hale* v. *Henkel,* 201 U. S. 43; *Wilson* v. *United States,* 221 U. S. 361; *Essgee Co.* v. *United States,* 262 U. S. 151. See also *United States* v. *Invader Oil Corp.,* 5 F. 2d 715. Moreover, the papers and effects which the privilege protects must be the private property of the person claiming the privilege, or at least in his possession in a purely personal capacity. *Boyd* v. *United States,* 116 U. S. 616. But individuals, when acting as representatives of a collective group, cannot be said to be exercising their personal rights and duties nor to be entitled to their purely personal privileges. Rather they assume the rights, duties and privileges of the artificial entity or association of which they are agents or officers and they are bound by its obligations. In their official capacity, therefore, they have no privilege against self-incrimination. And the official records and documents of the organization that are held by them in a representative rather than in a personal capacity cannot be the subject of the personal privilege against self-incrimination, even though production of the papers might tend to incriminate them personally. *Wilson* v. *United States, supra; Dreier* v. *United States,* 221 U. S. 394; *Baltimore & Ohio R. Co.* v. *Interstate Commerce Commission,* 221 U. S. 612; *Wheeler* v. *United States,* 226 U. S. 478; *Grant* v. *United States,* 227 U. S. 74; *Essgee Co.* v. *United States, supra.* Such records and papers are not the private records of the individual members or officers of the organization. Usually, if not always, they are open to inspection by the members and this right may be enforced on ap-